The Praise of Homage

Vandanastotra · Toh 1136 · Derge Tengyur
ཕྱག་འཚལ་བའི་བསྟོད་པ།

The Praise of Homage, known in Sanskrit as the Vandanastotra and in Tibetan as Phyag 'tshal ba'i bstod pa, is a devotional hymn in verse addressed to the Buddha. Opening with homage to all the Tathāgatas, it salutes the Buddha as the one who has abandoned attachment, aversion, and the great delusion of cyclic existence, as the vanquisher of Māra, and as the unequaled teacher of the three worlds, worshipped by gods and asuras. The verses also recall his birth as a son of the Śākya king in the renowned solar lineage and go on to praise the marks of his golden, mountain-like body, with each stanza closing in an expression of reverence. This work is Toh 1136 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the collection of praises, the class of hymns composed by Indian authors in honor of buddhas and other awakened beings.

In the language of India: bandanastotranāma
In the language of Tibet: The Praise of Homage

Homage to all the Tathāgatas.

You who have abandoned harmful attachment and aversion,
And the net of great delusion that is the round of existence,
Supreme Victor who bestows the supreme,
Supremely arisen Buddha, to you I pay homage.

Perfect Buddha who has fully and truly realized,
Worshipped by gods and asuras,
Teacher of the three worlds,
Unconquered and without equal,
Vanquisher of Māra's power, to you I pay homage.

Born as the son of the Śākya king,
Your lineage renowned as the solar clan,
Heroic and wondrous Buddha,
Gatherer of the whole host of qualities,
Worshipped by gods, humans and Vāyu, god of the wind, homage to you.

Your body like the peak of a golden mountain,
Possessing eyes like lotus petals,
Endowed with the color of gold,

Bearing the thirty-two major marks,
Auspicious one of excellent marks, homage to you.

With fire, with lightning, and with sparks,
Possessing an orb of a thousand sunbeams,
By which your power is adorned,
Peerless one endowed with power, homage to you.

Blazing with supreme glory,
Truly endowed with merit and with discipline,
Become the supreme lord of sages,
You who attained perfect awakening,
Before whom even the most proud bow down, homage to you.

You who bring benefit to sentient beings
And act with compassion for the sake of their happiness,
Having entered into the true meaning,
You went to the city of nirvāṇa, homage to you.

To this one, to whom mahoragas, kinnaras,
Gods and asuras bow down,
From my praise of the Victor,
Whatever merit I have gathered,
By that may all sentient beings
Come to realize awakening.

The Praise of Homage, composed by the master, the noble Nāgārjuna, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• In the sixth stanza, □□□□ is taken as an abbreviation of □□□□□□□□, "merit," and □□□□□ as "discipline" or "gentleness." The opening words of the final stanza, □□□□□□□, literally "by this," are construed loosely as referring to the Buddha honored by the classes of beings listed.

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.